

# FILM DOSSIER: THOR: THE HALLS OF HEL

---

Phase 4 · Film #6 (Saga Two, Film #6 · Overall Film #35)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

---

## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                                          |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                 | Saga Two #6 (Phase 4, Film #6) · MCU #35                                       |
| Phase                  | Phase 4, <b>The Secret Wars Saga</b>                                           |
| Real title             | <i><b>THOR: THE HALLS OF HEL</b></i>                                           |
| Decoy / codename title | <i><b>"BONE DRY"</b></i>                                                       |
| Release date           | <b>Friday, May 5, 2023</b>                                                     |
| Distributor            | Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures                                            |
| Director               | Taika Waititi                                                                  |
| Rating / runtime       | <b>PG-13 · 160 minutes</b>                                                     |
| Genre + second genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>dark fantasy / journey into the underworld</b> |

---

## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                           | Entry                                                 |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise is this? | <b>ESTHER SMILLEY</b> (Thor, film 4 of the franchise) |

| Character                  | Actor                                         | Age at release |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Thor, ruler of Asgard      | Esther Smilley                                | 40             |
| Hela                       | Cate Blanchett                                | 53             |
| Skurge the Executioner     | Karl Urban                                    | 50             |
| Loki                       | Tom Hiddleston                                | 42             |
| Frigga                     | Rene Russo                                    | 69             |
| Jane Foster                | Natalie Portman                               | 41             |
| Heimdall / Sif             | Idris Elba / Jaimie Alexander                 | 50 / 39        |
| Volstagg / Fandral / Hogun | Ray Stevenson / Zachary Levi / Tadanobu Asano | 58 / 42 / 49   |
| Beta Ray Bill              | Terry Crews                                   | 54             |
| Doctor Strange (cameo)     | Benedict Cumberbatch                          | 46             |
| Mephisto (post-credit)     | Ciarán Hinds                                  | 70             |

*Real-history note (locked): Ray Stevenson died on May 21, 2023, sixteen days after this film opens. This is his last appearance as Volstagg, and the film is dedicated "In memory of Ray Stevenson." Under the Casting Rules, Volstagg is not recast. Any future Thor film will address his passing in-universe, with respect.*

### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                    | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary comic(s) adapted | <b>Walter Simonson's <i>Thor</i> #360–362 (1985–86): Hela steals the souls of mortals.</b> Thor, Balder and the Warriors Three go into Hel to take them back. <b>Hela curses Thor</b> so that <b>he can't die but his bones will never heal</b> . <b>Skurge holds the bridge Gjallerbru alone</b> against the armies of the dead, and dies. |
| Supporting comics        | <i>Thor</i> #363–366 (1986, Thor fights on in armor, his bones shattered) · <i>Journey into Mystery</i> #102 (1964, Hela) · <i>Thor</i> #337 (Simonson, <b>Beta Ray Bill</b> )                                                                                                                                                              |
| Nerf check               | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> <b>Hela is Asgard's goddess of death</b> , the equal of Thor. <b>Her curse breaks Thor's body</b> , and <b>Thor keeps fighting</b> . <b>Skurge's last stand</b> is at full strength against thousands.                                                                                                  |

#### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | <b>97%</b> . Simonson's Hel arc, including <b>Gjallerbru</b> , which was promised in <i>Thor: The Twilight Sword</i> . |

### Straight from the page:

- **Hela takes mortal souls into Hel** (#360).
- **Thor** leads a war party into Hel: the **Warriors Three**, **Skurge**, and others (#360–361).
- **Hela curses Thor: he can't die, and his bones become brittle and never heal** (#361).
- **Skurge the Executioner** stays behind **alone at Gjallerbru**, the bridge out of Hel, with two M16 rifles, **holding back the armies of the dead** so the others can escape. "***He stood alone at Gjallerbru.***" (#362)
- **Thor** leaves Hel **wearing armor to hold her broken body together** (#362–363).

### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The **stolen souls come from the Great Society's destroyed Earth** (*The Black Priests*) | It ties the film to the Secret Wars Saga. Billions of dead souls flooded Hel, and Hela wants more. |

| **Doctor Strange** appears | His guilt: those souls are his doing |

### POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character            | 616 powers & abilities                                                                                                           | Shown in this film                                                                    | Held back (why)       | Match                                                                                         |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Thor</b>          | God-level strength; Mjolnir; the God Blast                                                                                       | <b>Fights through Hel with broken bones</b> , and her God Blast holds off Hela's army | The Odinfence (later) | <br>100%   |
| <b>Hela</b>          | <b>The Asgardian goddess of death: death-touch, curses</b> , command of <b>the armies of the dead</b> , near-invulnerable in Hel | <b>The curse on Thor</b> ; an army of the dead                                        | –                     | <br>100% |
| <b>Skurge</b>        | Near-Asgardian strength; his axe; <b>two M16s</b>                                                                                | <b>Holds Gjallerbru alone against thousands</b>                                       | –                     | <br>100% |
| <b>Beta Ray Bill</b> | Stormbreaker; class 100                                                                                                          | Joins the war party                                                                   | –                     | <br>100% |

## 4. STORY

| Field                       | Entry                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Logline</b>              | Billions of souls from a murdered world flood the halls of Hel, and its queen wants more. To take back the dead, Thor has to walk into the underworld and pay with her own body. |
| <b>Theme</b>                | <b>Sacrifice and redemption.</b> Skurge was a villain, and he dies a hero.                                                                                                       |
| <b>Villain / antagonist</b> | <b>Hela</b>                                                                                                                                                                      |

## What the movie is about

### ACT ONE: THE FLOOD OF SOULS

- **Monday, January 16, 2023. Hel is overflowing** with billions of souls from the destroyed Great Society Earth.
- **Hela**, swollen with power, **starts taking mortal souls from Midgard** too, including children in a New York hospital.
- **Doctor Strange** comes to Asgard: *"Those souls in Hel are there because of me. Help me get them back."*

### ACT TWO: INTO HEL

- **Thor** leads a war party into Hel: **Loki, Sif, the Warriors Three, Beta Ray Bill, and Skurge the Executioner**.
- **Hela** faces Thor and **curses her**: *"You shall never die, sister of storms. But your bones will never mend."*
- Thor's bones break with every blow, and she keeps going.

### ACT THREE: GJALLERBRU

- They free the stolen souls and **run for Gjallerbru**, the only bridge out of Hel.
- The **armies of the dead** are coming.
- **Skurge** stops on the bridge and turns around, alone, with his axe and **two rifles from Midgard**.

**SKURGE:** *"Go. I'll hold them."*

- **He stood alone at Gjallerbru**.
- Thor comes back to Asgard **encased in armor** to hold her broken body together. The children in the hospital wake up.
- At Skurge's funeral, **Volstagg** says only: *"Aye. He stood alone."*

## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | <b>Monday, January 16, 2023 → Monday, April 3, 2023.</b>                                                                          |
| Where it's set          | <b>Asgard · Hel</b> (practical underworld sets and New Zealand locations) · <b>Gjallerbru · New York</b> (the hospital)           |
| Relative to other films | <b>Four months after <i>Kraven's Last Hunt</i>.</b> Strange's guilt from <i>The Black Priests</i> is the reason the story starts. |

## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- **Thor in armor, cursed** and unbreakable.
- **Skurge's sacrifice**, and **Hela's defeat**.

### World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed                       | How it appears         | Payoff  |
|----------------------------|------------------------|---------|
| The cost of the Incursions | Billions of dead souls | Phase 5 |
| Strange and Thor           | Allied by guilt        | Phase 5 |

### Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

| Seed                | How it appears        | What it means                                                                                 |
|---------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mephisto's interest | The post-credit scene | <b>Mephisto is collecting souls from dead universes.</b> Doom's mother is among his hostages. |

## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mid-credit scene       | ✅ <b>"ARMOR."</b> Thor, in her new armor, tries to sit on the throne and <b>can't bend</b> . Loki laughs until he cries.                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Post-credit scene      | ✅ <b>"THE OTHER HELL." Mephisto's realm.</b> The souls <b>Hela lost</b> drift into Mephisto's hands. He smiles. <b>Cynthia von Doom</b> , in chains, watches them arrive.<br><b>MEPHISTO:</b> <i>"More guests, Cynthia. Your boy's friends keep killing worlds. It's marvelous for business."</i> <b>CUT TO BLACK. "THOR WILL RETURN."</b> |
| Secret shoot codenames | Mid-credit: <b>"POSTURE."</b> Post-credit: <b>"HOTEL CALIFORNIA."</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

## CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building

· [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline